LESSON 10

Für Elise
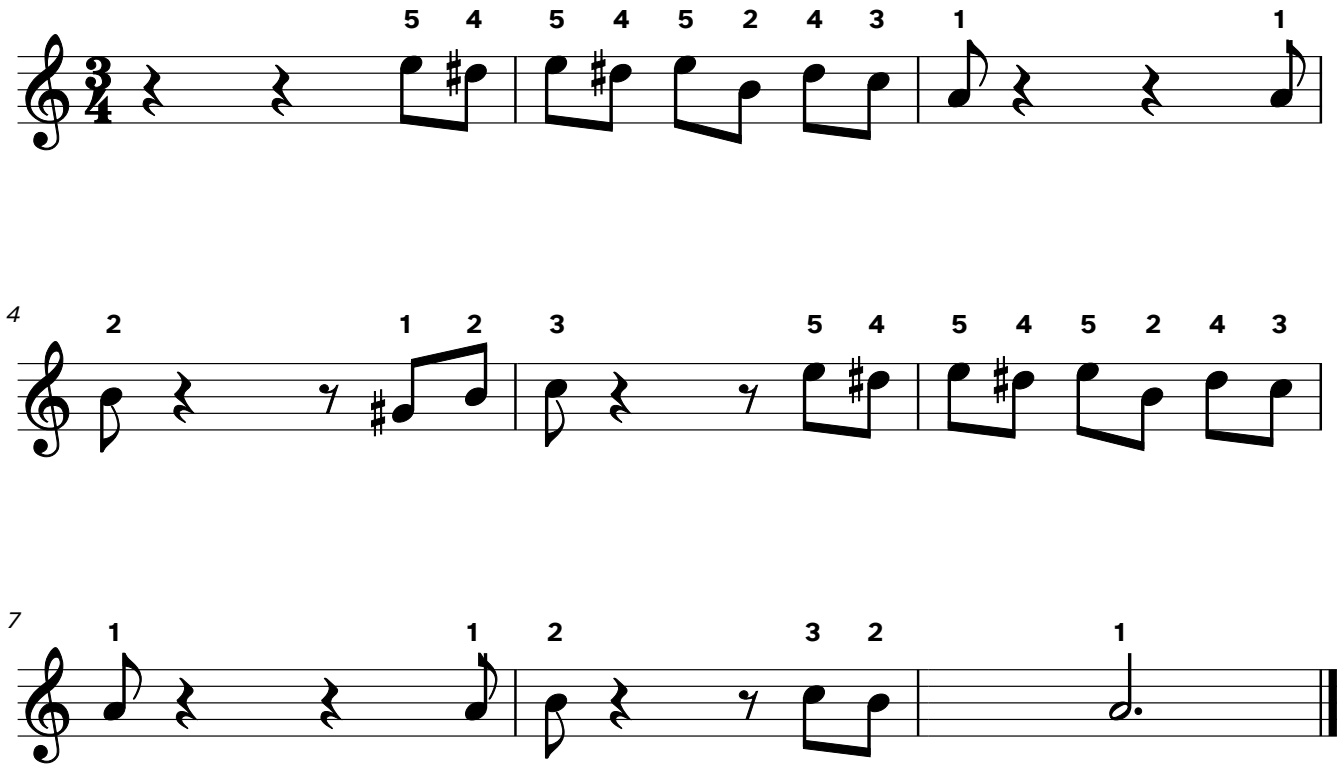
Beethoven wrote it in 1810 for a mystery Elise: the most famous piano piece in the world.

LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen once, then hum along.

THE WOW MOMENT
☆ **The most famous piano piece in the world:** play the first line to anyone, anywhere, and they will know it.

1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing to each note. No words this time: hum it. Then play the tune with the right hand; the left hand joins on page 3.

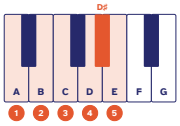


☐ Listened and pointed ☐ Hummed the famous line ☐ Played the tune

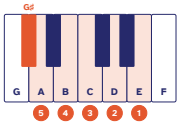
2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

RIGHT HAND · A POSITION



LEFT HAND · AN OCTAVE LOWER



NEW IN THIS SONG

The A position: both hands on A. **D♯** is D's best friend, the black key to its right; the right thumb dips to **G♯**. **3/4:** three beats a bar.

THE RHYTHM

Count ONE two three. Clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey, open your hands on a rest.

THE TIME

$\frac{3}{4}$

Top 3: three beats in every bar: ONE two three.
Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

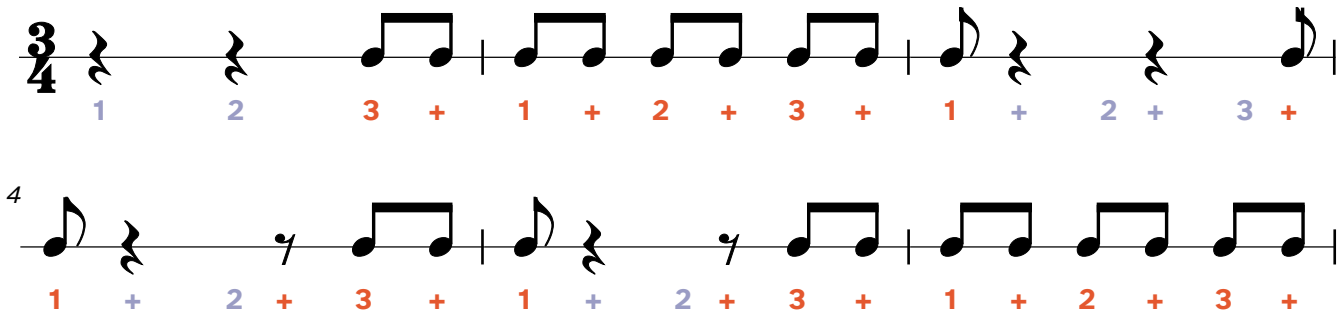
THE NOTES

two quavers: run-ning
1 beat

crotchet: walk
1 beat

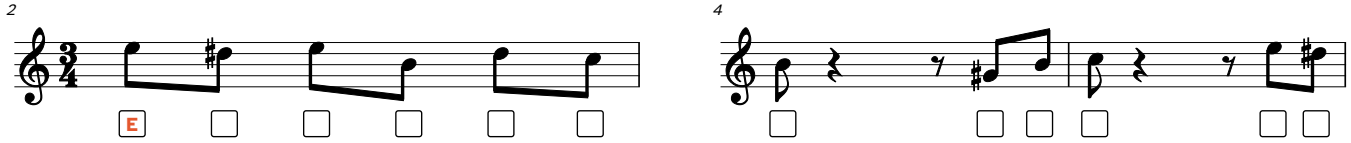
crotchet rest: wait
1 beat

dotted minim: hold-2-3
3 beats



THE NOTES

Write the letter under each note of the famous line; D♯ is D with its sharp.



SPOT THE MISTAKE Your teacher plays D instead of D♯. Put up your hand: the spooky colour is gone. Then the other way: G instead of G♯.

- [ ] **Counted in three**
- [ ] **Clapped it**
- [ ] **Wrote the letters**
- [ ] **Spotted the mistake**

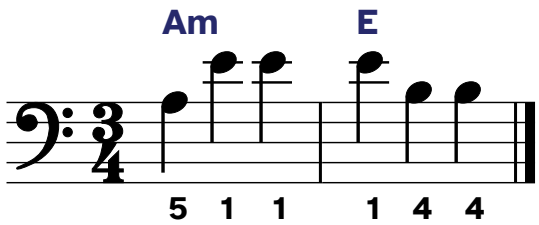
3 Lead sheet

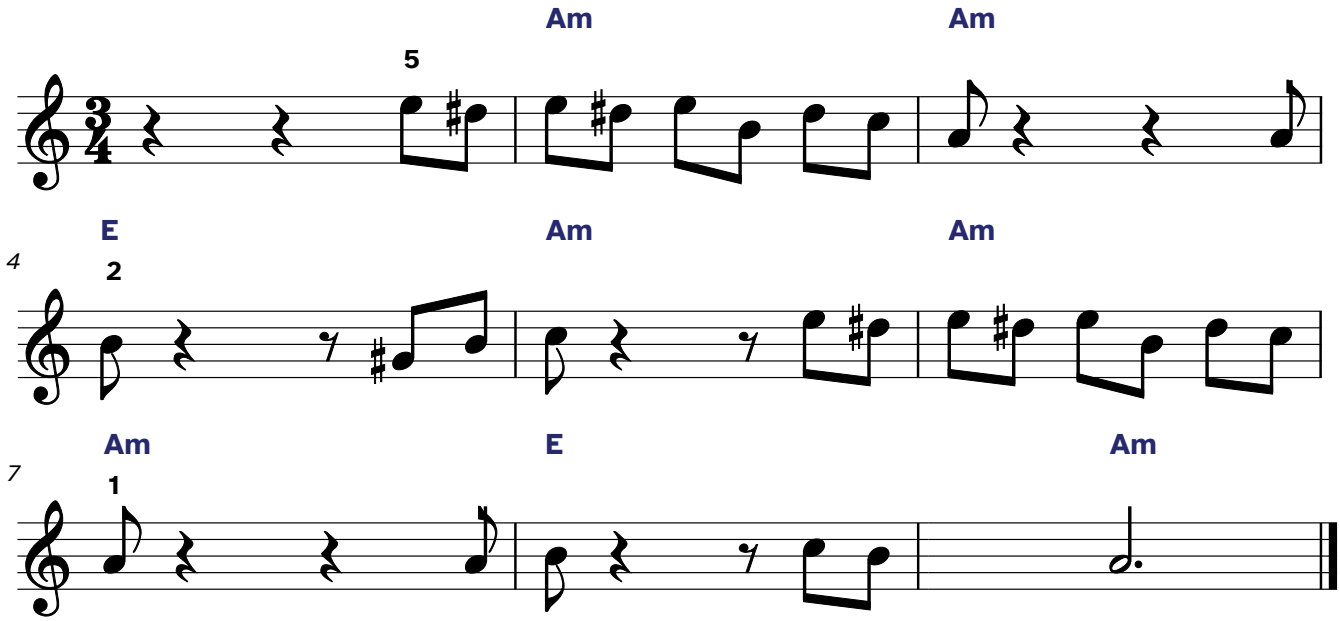
The tune and its names, Am and E, in three-time. The left hand plays pattern 4 from the names: oom-pah-pah. Bar 1 has no name: the right hand starts alone.

PATTERN 4 · OOM-PAH-PAH

The waltz pattern: the root on ONE, then a higher note on two and three. Am: A, E, E. E: E, B, B.

E **Am**





1 Tune alone, right hand

2 Pattern alone, reading only the names: ONE two three

3 Together, very slowly

4 · CHECK

☐ I can count in three ☐ I can find D♯ and G♯ ☐ I can play the famous line

I can play it: colour a step each time you climb

	Slowly	Steady	With the band	Fast
From the notes				
From the names				

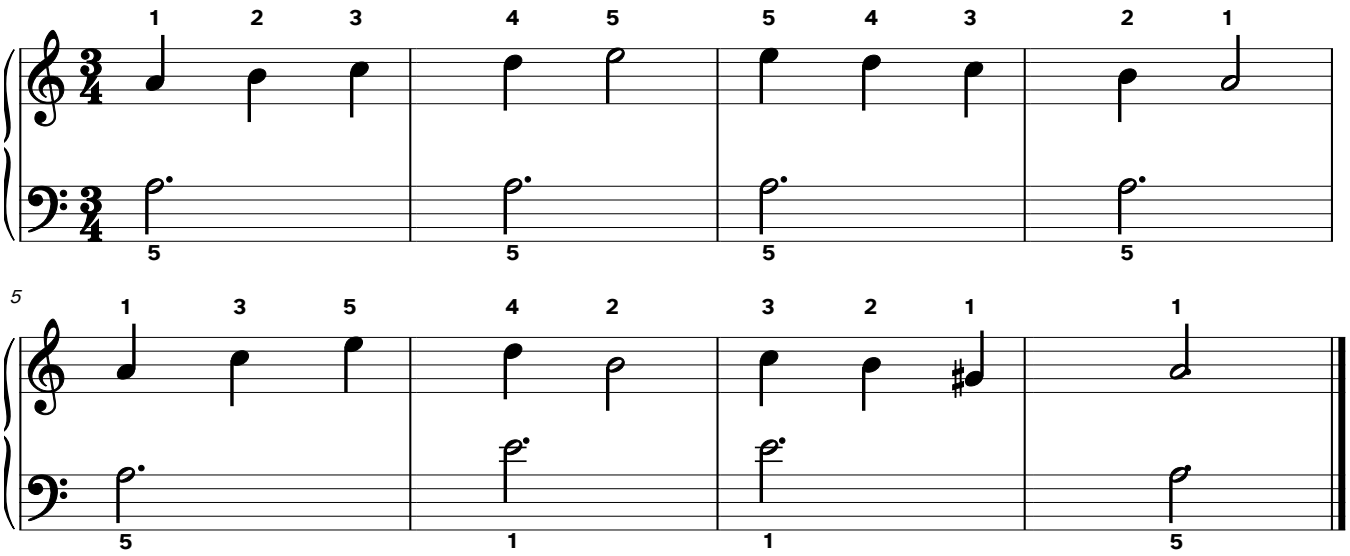
TEACHER ☐ Pass ☐ Not yet

+ More to play

Two more in three-time: a ghost walk in the A position, and a waltz back home in C.

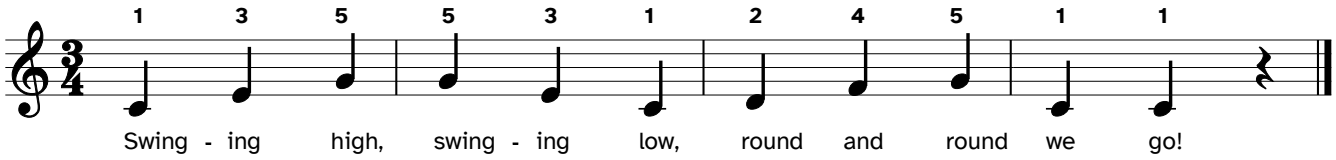
GHOST WALK

The A position, hands together: the right hand walks the five keys while the left hand holds its root. Spooky, soft, smooth.



SWING SONG

A waltz for the C position: three beats in a bar, lean on ONE, like a swing.



MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole piece that way. Can your teacher guess which?

- ☐ **Ghostly: very soft, the D♯ a whisper**
- ☐ **From the names: your teacher plays the tune, you play the roots A and E**
- ☐ **Swapped: the left hand plays the famous line an octave lower**

5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the piece once
2. Line 1, the famous bit, three times
3. Both hands, slowly
4. The roots from the names, with the band

☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

☐ **Played Ghost Walk** ☐ **Played Swing Song**